

FORMAT FOR CAPSTONE PROJECT PROPOSALS
Bachelor of Science in Information Technology

General Formatting Guidelines

- Paper size – 8.5"x11" (short bond paper)
- Single-sided printing
- Font – Arial, 12
- Spacing – 1.5 for the main manuscript; preliminary and back pages – single space
- Margins – top, bottom, and right – 1" while left is 1.5"
- Justification – justified
- Figures and tables are centered
- Format – APA 7th edition

Parts of the Capstone Paper – Preliminary Pages

Preliminary pages shall be numbered consecutively in Arabic Numerals, beginning with the first preliminary page. The title page shall be considered page one (1) but will not be numbered accordingly. Page numbers shall be placed at the center of the page and .5 inches from the bottom of the page (footer).

Preliminary pages consist of all pages preceding the first page of Chapter One. Preliminary pages shall follow the order below.

1. Title Page

The title page includes the authors' names, the submission statement, the name of the University, the address of the University, the month and year of submission, and the capstone members.

The capstone title appears in all capital letters; and is double-spaced and centered. Names of authors will be in upper- and lower-case.

The submission statement is printed in upper- and lower-case letters, single-spaced, and centered.

TITLE OF THE PROJECT/PROPOSAL

A Capstone Project Proposal
Submitted to the Faculty of the
Department of Information Technology
Mountain Province State University
Bontoc, Mountain Province

In Partial Fulfillment of the Requirements for the Degree
Bachelor of Science in Information Technology

By:

*Names of the members of
group arranged
alphabetically*

|

*Month and Year of
Submission*

2. **Approval Sheet**

The Approval Sheet shall bear the signatures of the panel of examiners with the grade obtained during the defense.

The Department Chair shall sign to indicate the acceptance and approval of the capstone project/proposal in partial fulfillment of the requirements of the degree.

The approval sheet shall follow this format:



Republic of the Philippines
Cordillera Administrative Region
Mountain Province State University
Bontoc, Mountain Province

APPROVAL SHEET

This thesis entitled _____ prepared and submitted by _____, in partial fulfillment of the requirements for the degree **Bachelor of Science in Information Technology**, has been examined and accepted.]

Adviser

APPROVED BY THE EXAMINATION COMMITTEE

Chairperson

Member

Member

Proposal Defense:

Rating: _____

Final Defense:

Rating: _____

Accepted in partial fulfillment of the requirements for the degree Bachelor of Science in Information Technology.

Endorsed:

Program Chairperson

Approved:

AREL B. SIA-ED, Ed.D.
Campus Director

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Certification

A separate certification shall be attached that will indicate that the submitted capstone project/proposal is recommended for oral exam. This shall be signed by the adviser and course facilitator before the paper is routed to the panel members.

The Certification shall be worded as follows:

The Capstone Project/Proposal entitled **(title of the capstone project)** prepared and submitted by (names of authors) in partial fulfillment of the requirements for the degree Bachelor of Science in Information Technology has been examined and is hereby recommended for Oral Examination on **(scheduled date of defense)**.

3. **Dedication and Acknowledgement**

Dedication and acknowledgment pages are personal pages for students to express their gratitude to all who helped in the capstone project/proposal; it is a special recognition of special assistance. Usually follows formal writing and institutional format, if prescribed.

The text for the dedication page begins with the word “To”. Dedication begins with the word “To”.

4. Abstract

The abstract discusses in 250 to 300 words what is the project about. It is a summary of the paper. It contains the purpose of the project, what was done (methodology), what was found (results), what was concluded (conclusions), and what is recommended (recommendations).

This shall be attached in the final paper but it is not required in the proposal.

5. Table of Contents

The heading TABLE OF CONTENTS in all capital letters is centered. The listing of titles is at the left margin. All titles of major divisions that follow the table of contents (sections on preliminaries, parts, chapters, appendices) and at least first-order subheadings must be listed.

6. List of Tables/Figures

Tables have a row-column structure in which numerical data are presented. Figures on the other hand refer to all displays other than a table, such as photographs, drawings, graphs, charts, and samples of student work. The heading, LIST OF TABLES or LIST OF FIGURES appears in capital letters, centered on the page.

7. List of Back Pages

The back pages are also listed in the Table of Contents. These include the references and the appendices.

Parts After Preliminary Pages

Chapters

Each chapter has these required elements: chapter number, chapter title, and headings. The chapter number and title are centered in all capital letters. Each chapter begins on a new page but sections and subsections, always follow each other without gaps in text. Do not start a separate page for each section or subsection.

Reference List

The Reference list is an alphabetical list of works cited in chapters one to five. The title References appears in all capital letters. Follow APA 7th edition for the format of the reference list.

Entries in the reference list should be made as hanging indents. The first line is flushed with the left margin and subsequent lines are indented. Entries are double-spaced. Titles of books and journals are in italics; they are not underscored.

Appendix

Each appendix has these required elements: appendix letter and appendix title. The appendix letter and title are centered. The first letter of the Appendix and its letter designation are capitalized (example: Appendix A).

Chapter I – The Project and Its Background

Chapter 1 talks about the project, what problem it is trying to solve, and the background of why the project is to be done.

1. **Introduction** – what the project is, introduce the system and/or the project, what are the intended features of the project, and tells why it is going to be developed
2. **Project Framework** – on what theories and concepts is the project anchored on; the solution to a problem is usually framed by theories (established knowledge); includes conceptual framework – how to go about the project; follows the INPUT-PROCESS-OUTPUT model

3. **Statement of Objectives** – the intention of the project. We shall follow the **design, develop, and implement** as the direction of the objectives. ***For the other objectives, you can discuss this in the background of the study.***
4. **Importance of the Project** – what are the benefits of the project to the different stakeholders especially the community if it is solving a problem in the community; the project can also be important to an organization.
5. **Definition of terms** – operational definition; how the terms are used in the project; define the important terms as used in the paper

Chapter 2 – Related Literature and Systems

1. **Geographical approach** – foreign and local
2. Separate literature and systems (existing)

While this may be in Chapter 2, doing a review of literature and studies is one of the first steps undertaken in a capstone project. Students are required to have a minimum of twenty (20) related literature and systems.

In capstone projects as compared to research, aside from a literature review, there is a need to do a systems review; to investigate the local and global scene of what systems or applications are already in use and the market in the area of interest.

A comprehensive review of literature and systems is important so that the students will have an idea of what solutions are already developed, what can still be developed or what enhancement can they introduce to existing systems to propose solutions to emerging problems.

Review of literature and systems have the following purposes: (a) Understand and summarize the major ideas on a subject/topic; (b) Show awareness of the scope of the research/study/system that has already been conducted/developed on a subject area; (c) Identify new and emerging trends and knowledge in a subject area; and, (d) Highlight gaps in the subject area where new activities may be warranted

Chapter 3– **Project Design and Methodology** – describes the programming techniques and design steps including documentation and illustration of system requirements. This is to document what the students did in designing their capstone project and to enable readers of the manuscript to be able to validate or replicate what was done in this project.

3.1 **Project Design and Analysis** – describes the design of the system using diagrams

- User requirement analysis – USE CASE – describes the users and their system activities – who does what discussion
- Process Analysis – includes DFD (data flow diagram) which shows the input and output and how each function is flowing in the system – between and among users and entities. Includes context level DFD, first and second level DFD
- Activity diagram – flowchart of activities
- FDD – functional decomposition diagram
- Data Storage Requirements which include ERD, storage design, and structure chart which will show the relationship of the program modules

3.2 **population and locale of the project** – describes from whom data will be gathered and where the system/product will be used

3.3 **Data instrumentation** – tools used to gather data like questionnaire, interview guide, observation guide

3.4 **Development process**—details how data collected are analyzed to help in the design of the system; it also identifies what model was used in the development phase. Using the development model, what are the phases involved in the development cycle and details are

all the tools used in the project? The development model, development approach, and software development tools will all be discussed in this section,

3.5 Schedule and timeline – gives the schedule and timeline of the activities for the design and development of the project. It may include any of the following, whichever applies to the group, the Gantt chart (activities and their schedules), the activity graph (details of the activities and their sequence including the length of time for each activity, CPM (critical path method – show how the project is finished earlier without sacrificing the quality of deliverables,

3.6 Budget and Cost Management

- **detailed budget proposal** – the costs for the project and the rationale of each cost item
- **Cost Benefit Analysis** is computed and discussed. This will include the computation of the ROI.

3.7 Verification, Validation, and Testing – this section discusses how important is testing of the system and how it will be done

Back Pages

- References – APA format
- Appendices
 - CVs of the Project Team Members and Grammarian